



Everything You Need to Host Your First Mahjong Night

A checklist for setting up your table, your space, and your players, whether you're playing casual house rules or the full official card.

The essentials

CAN'T PLAY WITHOUT

- ☐ **A mahjong tile set.** A standard American set has 152 tiles (plus jokers), enough for four players.
- ☐ **Four racks**, one per player, to hold everyone's tiles upright and hidden from the rest of the table.
- ☐ **A table with room for the wall.** Tiles get built into a wall in the middle before play starts, so you need real space beyond just four place settings.
- ☐ **Enough chairs**, one per player, at a height that lets everyone see over their rack comfortably.
- ☐ **Good lighting over the table.** Tiles have small printed details, dim lighting slows the game down more than people expect.
- ☐ **This year's card**, if you're playing official NMJL scoring, or your group's own house rules written down somewhere, if you're playing casual.
- ☐ **A way to keep score.** A pad and pen works. The Mahj Report app does the math for you and keeps a season going across multiple nights.

Table setup

EASY TO FORGET

The mahjong table is fully spoken for once the wall goes up. There's no room left on it for anything else.

- ☐ **Two little side tables per mahjong table**, one shared between each pair of neighboring seats.
- ☐ **Coasters** on those side tables, if the surface would take a ring from a cold glass.
- ☐ **Napkins or small plates** at each side table, for snacks people want within reach.

Setting the mood

OPTIONAL, WORTH IT

- ☐ **A mahjong playlist on Spotify.** Search "mahjong" for ready made playlists.
- ☐ **Snacks and drinks**, set up separate from the side tables if you're feeding a crowd.
- ☐ **A small prize for the night's winner.** Doesn't need to be expensive, see themahjreport.com/mahjong-night-prizes.html for ideas.

Before your first shuffle

QUICK CHECKS

- ☐ Confirm you have enough players for at least one full table (four), or a plan for who sits where if you have more.
- ☐ Decide up front whether you're playing casual or official rules, and make sure everyone at the table knows which.
- ☐ If anyone's new, a quick walk through of your house rules before the first hand saves confusion later.

Starting from nothing?

A shopping list lives at themahjreport.com/mahjong-night-checklist.html: what to look for in a tile set, racks, side tables, and coasters, plus what to search for on Amazon.

Tile set

152 to 166 tiles, four racks with pushers, a carrying case.

Side tables

Small and foldable, two per table.

Racks & pushers

Buy separately for a color per player.

Coasters

A set of four or eight.